On November 7, John McCloy and Adlai Stevenson informed Vasilii Kuznetsov that the United States was indeed prepared to accept the earlier Soviet offer to allow *de visu* inspection in neutral waters of ships carrying missiles back to the Soviet Union. The problem of inspection was now removed from the list of American-Soviet difficulties, becoming a problem for the Soviets alone. From that point on, Khrushchev owned it. The dry cargo ship *Metallurg Anosov*, which left Cuba on November 6 with eight missiles on board, was instructed by telegram that day to show the missiles on demand to ships under the United Nations flag but not to ones flying the American flag. On the following day, the order was changed: the missiles were to be shown to American helicopters. On the day after that, November 9, the captains of Soviet ships were instructed to remove canvas covers and show the Americans missiles on deck without opening the tween decks.[28]

The *Divnogorsk* under Captain Myroshnichenko was among the first Soviet ships to comply with that request. But the Soviets did their best to complicate and slow down the process by filing protests against American actions that allegedly exceeded official agreements. On November 9, the day on which the USS *Blandy* inspected the *Divnogorsk* and approached the *Aleksandrovsk*, the Soviets protested the actions of American ships forcing inspections of Soviet cargoes. The *Aleksandrovsk*, the *Divnogorsk*, and another ship, the *Volgoles*, were mentioned in the diplomatic note. The *Volgoles*, with seven missiles on board, was approached by the American destroyer *Saufley* (DD 465) on the morning of November 8: confirming that it had missiles on board, its captain refused to show them to the Americans, as current instructions allowed him to show missiles only to ships under the UN flag. He complied with the American demand on the following day, November 9, after receiving orders to show the missiles.

Vice Admiral Charles Wellborn, the chairman of the American delegation to the United Nations Military Staff Committee, responded to the Soviet protest by pointing out that under no circumstances were any threats made against Soviet ships or inspections forced on them. If the *Volgoles* had shown the missiles immediately, it would not have been approached again. Regarding the *Divnogorsk*, Wellborn suggested that the inspection took so long because of the language barrier. He found it more difficult to explain what had occurred with the *Aleksandrovsk*, as that ship was not listed by the